

EssayQ
[UPSC
2020]

There can be no social Justice without economic prosperity, but economic prosperity without social Justice is meaningless. [100M]

→ 26 November, 1949, India produced the greatest text of the world, that is, the Constitution of India. It ensures in its beginning, values such as Justice, Liberty, Equality, etc. Justice, as 'Social Justice' without Economic prosperity is not possible. Economic prosperity and social Justice are interdependent. Prosperity fuels Justice by providing resources and Justice gives meaning to prosperity by ensuring it reaches everyone.

Social Justice refers to a state where all citizens have equal rights, access to both the monetary and non-monetary benefits of a political system, regardless of their caste, class, gender, religion or economic status. But if the prosperity

is unequally distributed, it can create deep social divide.

In a liberal democratic country like, India, the values mentioned in the constitution could only be achieved when these Ideals are followed to its reality. Without economic growth, governments can't mobilize funds for programs like Education, healthcare, housing, etc.

With the emergence of Industrial Revolution in 16th-17th century, there was a boom in Capitalist - worker class of society. Where people witnessed Brutal Naked oppression of humanity.

It created a highly unequal society where massive exploitation started due to negative liberty. This inequality and the gap in the system is well depicted in the famous Economists' book

Thomas Piketty and Lucas
Chabal in their book
British Raj to Billionaire Raj

It shows how Rate of Return on Capital dominates Rate of Return on Human Capital.

In a liberal democracy like India, sustainable development, social harmony, true progress can be achieved when prosperity be made inclusive, lifting all sections of society, especially the marginalized.

Karl Marx who became the torchbearer of revolutionary socialism, in his book Das Kapital talked about the concept of collective property to create a classless society. His theory Each according to his need and each according to his capacity promoted equality in the society. However, the practical implementation of his theory failed to deliver its ideals.

The extreme form of both Liberty and Equality dismantled the system creating havoc in the society.

So, a fine balance between both gave rise to the concept of Justice. John Rawls proposed a Justice-oriented theory in his experiment 'Veil of Ignorance' and quoted ^{in his book} Justice as Fairness to redefine the

discourse on equity. He advocates inequality with condition, that it should favour the weakest section of the society.

Economy can't work without material incentives which help grow Economic Activity. This generates ~~at~~ employment and eventually uplifts the marginalised section of the society.

As mentioned by Martin Luther King, "Poverty anywhere is threat to Everywhere?" is rightly justified for social upliftment to make a nation progress in true sense.

Despite economic liberalisation of 1991 that tilted India towards a market-oriented economy, the constitutional vision of socialism did not fade away.

This was done to promote economic prosperity so that disadvantaged groups don't continue to suffer and efforts to reduce inequality don't fall short.

The various schemes were ~~promoted~~ to implemented to promote socialism in India

like Right to work, ~~2005~~

under Article 41 promotes

MGNREGA, 2005 & ~~at~~

Right to food (Article 47),

to promote NFSA, 2013,

Right to education, ~~2009~~ Article 21A, Article 45) ~~for~~ etc.

Justice and Economic prosperity both go hand-in-hand so that ideals mentioned in the Constitution be achieved in reality.

The Gandhian vision of Ramrajya of converting a

State into a stateless society
is although a utopian concept
but this ideal can be
given a thought with
everyone's effort to make
it the Real Ramrajya.

An empowered society will be
where

No one is food-deprived.

No one is enslaved

No one is despotic.